

Mobile Skype

Skype offers a low-bandwidth mobile version, designed for GPRS/EDGE access

Sony Ericsson models

Sony Ericsson Xperia Arc (₹28,990), Neo (₹24,990) and Play (₹32,000) are now available for pre-order in India

The new Apple iPad 2, compared to Motorola Xoom and Samsung Galaxy Tab 10.1

The latest Apple tablet, the iPad 2 has been officially released. The new device was unveiled by Apple's CEO Steve Jobs, who briefly returned from his extended medical leave. The excitement within Apple Inc. was quite visible as well. Dressed in his trademark blue jeans and black turtleneck sweater, Jobs joked to the audience at the San Francisco launch, "I just didn't want to miss today."

The iPad 2 is 33 per cent thinner and 15 per cent lighter than the predecessor. The iPad 2 is powered by a 1 GHz dual core A5 processor. There is no clarity on how much RAM the iPad 2 has, but it is expected that it is exactly double of the 256 MB in its predecessor. Apple also said that the new iPad 2 will have 9 times more powerful graphics. The battery life remains the same at 10 hours. The device ships with the latest version of the iOS

	Apple iPad 2	Motorola Xoom	Samsung Galaxy Tab 10.1
Platform	iOS 4.3	Android 3.0	Android 3.0
Display	9.7-inch	10.1-inch	10.1-inch
Resolution	1024 x 768	1280 x 800	1280 x 800
Processor	1 GHz dual-core Apple A5	1 GHz dual-core NVIDIA Tegra 2	1 GHz dual-core
Memory	512 MB	1 GB RAM	NA
Storage	16GB / 32GB / 64GB	32GB	16GB / 32GB
Front camera	VGA	2 megapixel	2 megapixel
Rear camera	5 megapixel (720p HD video)	5 megapixel (720p HD video)	8 megapixel (720p HD video)
Wi-Fi	802.11a/b/g/n	802.11a/b/g/n	802.11a/b/g/n
Bluetooth	2.1 + EDR	2.1 + EDR	
Battery	6600 mAh	6,500 mAh	6860 mAh
Weight	1.33 pounds (Wi-Fi version)	1.6 pounds	1.3 pounds
Price	\$499 onwards	\$600 onwards	NA

4.3, which is available across iOS devices for the iPhone4, iPhone 3GS and the iPod. With the HDMI out feature, you can connect your iPad to a TV and mirror the iPad display or enjoy multimedia content on the larger screen. However, users will need to buy the HDMI cable which costs about US\$ 30. Also, the iPad 2 will be available in white and black colour options. What the iPad 2 misses out on is its

Retina Display. The Indian iPad was launched in late January, with prices starting at ₹27,900 for the base model. The updated prices begin at ₹24,500. With queues again this time, we're sure we won't be seeing the iPad 2 in India anytime soon, in fact, it might even be next January.

The Samsung Galaxy Tab also got a lot cheaper, falling unofficially in price to ₹24,900 on online retail sites such as Flip-

kart and Letsbuy. Amazingly, the Samsung Galaxy Tab was first launched in India five months ago in November at ₹38,000, before getting an official price drop to ₹31,199 in late December.

Of course, 10.1-inch and 8.9-inch versions of the Galaxy Tab are also in the pipeline, but, there is no news of Samsung's plans to update the hardware of the already retailing 7-inch Galaxy Tab. ■

HTC Desire Z

HTC has launched the Desire Z in India, pricing it at ₹25,590. Based on Android 2.2 Froyo (Gingerbread) with the Sense UI, the Desire Z has a 3.7-inch touchscreen (no Super LCD in India) and a full four-line hardware QWERTY keypad.

The aluminium unibody-encased HTC Desire Z slides with a 'pop hinge' design, and the keyboard interestingly also features two customizable keys. HTC is clearly aiming at the professional market as well as a social networking one, inter-

estingly also including a unified email inbox.

The Desire Z is powered by an 800MHz Scorpion processor with an Adreno 205 GPU (Qualcomm 7230 chipset), running with 512MB of RAM. It has 1.5GB of inbuilt storage that is expandable to 32GB with a microSD card. The Desire Z's 5MP autofocus camera is equipped with LED flash, and is capable of



720p HD video recording. It is a speedy 3G device, with support for HSDPA at 14.4 Mbps, and HSUPA at 5.76 Mbps. The 1300

mAh battery onboard is manufacturer rated to provide up to 430 hours of standby time, and nearly 10 hours of talk time.

Featuring Android 2.2 Froyo skinned with the acclaimed Sense UI, the Desire Z also has access to HTC Locations for their mapping needs, and HTCSense.com for remote access and wiping functions, as well as backup and cloud storage. As reported earlier though, the phone is due to receive an update to Android 2.3 Gingerbread sometime in the second quarter of 2011.

In other news, the HTC Merge world phone is now available for pre-order in India for ₹35,000, listed on the Letsbuy web site. ■